

SOP — SMS Templates by Preset

Audience: Mike — daily text outreach.

Purpose: SMS templates built around proven distress-real-estate sales psychology, written to sound human and route every conversation to our local team. No reciprocity offers we can't fulfill (no 1-pagers, guides, etc.). No formulaic "reply yes" CTAs. Natural endings that trail off like a real text.

Why these convert

Most wholesale SMS reads: introduce yourself → say what you do → ask if interested. Same script every other investor uses — homeowners delete on autopilot.

These templates lead with **the homeowner's emotional reality first**. Every Day 1 opens by validating what they're going through, not announcing what we want. The pitch is the second message, not the first. And every CTA reads like an actual person texting, not a sales bot.

The 7 techniques baked into every template:

Technique	Why it works on distress homeowners
Pattern interrupt	They've been blasted by 20+ wholesalers — first 8 words must NOT sound like a wholesaler
Validation first	They feel shame, fear, exhaustion. Acknowledging it disarms the wall
Curiosity gap	"There's a rule most people don't know about" — earns the next message
Social proof	"I've helped a bunch of folks in your exact spot"
Specific situational reference	"Your case from [court]" or "after [decedent]'s passing" — proves we're not blast-spamming
Local team framing	"Our team's local" — we're not a national wholesale shop
Take-away close	"If not now, no worries" — lower pressure raises response rate

No formulaic CTAs. Endings trail off like a real person texting:

- "Give us a call when you have a sec — {{phone}}"
- "{{phone}} when you want to chat"
- "Hit us up at {{phone}}"
- "Number's {{phone}}, our team's local"
- "Call us at {{phone}}, anytime"

Different across templates so the cadence doesn't sound copy-paste.

What's different per stage of distress

LIS PENDENS (just got served, heart racing): Reframe panic into agency. "You have time. You have options most people don't know."

SHERIFF SALE (deadline pressure): Don't add urgency — they're already feeling it. Validate their stress, then offer calm.

PROBATE (grief + admin overload): Don't pitch. Offer presence. Honor their timeline.

REDEMPTION WINDOW (despair + last chance): Hope angle. "Wait — most people don't know this still works."

Variables you'll substitute

`{{first}}`, `{{address}}`, `{{auction}}`, `{{decedent}}`, `{{relationship}}`, `{{me}}`, `{{phone}}`.
Make sure your DataSift bulk-SMS column mapping is set before sending.

1. Lis Pendens — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: Got served papers in the last few weeks. Heart racing. Probably haven't told family yet. Already googled "what happens after foreclosure filing" 30 times.

Our hook: Validation + curiosity ("you have more time than you think")

Day 1 — Variant A: The "60-day rule" hook (CURIOSITY)

`{{first}}`, you don't know me – I'm with a small Dayton home-buying team. Saw your case got filed on `{{address}}`. There's a 60-day rule most homeowners in your spot don't know about that gives you breathing room. Easier to walk through on the phone. Give us a call when you have a sec – `{{phone}}`.

Day 1 — Variant B: Validation + take-away (EMPATHY)

`{{first}}`, getting served papers is one of the worst feelings. Our team's local Dayton – we've helped a bunch of folks in your exact spot. Not pushing, but happy to walk through what's worked. Call us when you can – `{{phone}}`.

Day 1 — Variant C: Direct + specific (DIRECTNESS)

{{first}}, your foreclosure case was filed at Montgomery Common Pleas. Most people in your spot have 4 paths forward – only 1 is selling. Our team works through them with you. {{phone}}, anytime.

Day 2 — Following up

{{first}}, no rush – just wanted to make sure my note didn't get lost. On {{address}}, the bank has a script they follow and most homeowners don't realize it. Give us a call if it'd help to talk it through. {{phone}}.

Day 3 — Final + soft take-away

{{first}}, last note – I won't keep texting. If you ever want a real conversation about your options on {{address}}, our team's here. {{phone}}. Otherwise wishing you well.

2. Lis Pendens — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Same as Mont but Columbus market — higher home values, more equity at stake, more skeptical of investors (more competition in market).

Our hook: Equity protection angle (they have more to lose than they realize)

Day 1 — Variant A: Equity protection (LOSS AVERSION)

{{first}} – Columbus local here. Your case on {{address}} just hit the docket. Most homeowners don't know: if the bank forecloses, ALL your equity goes to them. There are 3 ways to keep yours. Give us a call when you can – {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant B: Local credibility (TRUST-BUILDING)

Hey {{first}}, our team's based in Columbus – actual local buyers, not a call center. Saw your case on {{address}} got filed. We've worked with a bunch of folks 2-3 streets over from you. {{phone}} when you want to talk.

Day 1 — Variant C: Curiosity + outcome (FUTURE PACING)

{{first}}, quick thing on {{address}}: do you know what happens on day 91 after the foreclosure case is filed? Most people don't, and the timing matters. Our team can walk you through it. {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, hey – circling back. Our team helps a couple of Columbus homeowners a month in your spot. The biggest mistake we see is waiting too long because the bank seems quiet. They get loud fast. Call us when you have a minute – {{phone}}.

Day 3 — Final

{{first}}, last text on {{address}}. The way our team works isn't by pressuring – we lay out options and you pick. If that ever sounds useful, {{phone}}. Best of luck either way.

3. Lis Pendens — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Smaller community. Word travels. Probably knows someone else this happened to. Skeptical of out-of-towners.

Our hook: Hometown trust + neighborly tone

Day 1 — Variant A: Hometown trust (LOCAL CREDIBILITY)

{{first}}, this is {{me}} – our team's local Greene County. Saw your case got filed on {{address}}. Greene's a small place and these things move faster than people expect. No pitch – but happy to share what to watch for. {{phone}} whenever.

Day 1 — Variant B: Neighborly help (SOCIAL PROOF)

{{first}}, I'm sure this is the last thing you needed. Our team's Greene County and we've watched this play out for 4-5 neighbors over the years. Some kept their place, some sold to us. Either way we can help. Call us at {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Honest + plain (DIRECTNESS)

{{first}}, won't waste your time. {{address}} foreclosure case – our team's local Greene County, we have cash, we close fast if you decide to sell. If you'd rather keep it, we know good attorneys here too. {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – most folks in Greene think they have months. Sheriff sale schedules here are tight. Quick check-in – how are you feeling about the situation? Call us when you have a sec, {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. Greene's a tight community and our team's not going anywhere – if anything changes on {{address}} or you want a sounding board, {{phone}}.

4. Sheriff Sale — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: Sale on the calendar. Either resigned ("it's over") or scrambling ("how do I stop this"). Probably gotten 30+ calls/texts from other buyers this week.

Our hook: Acknowledge the noise, then differentiate

Day 1 — Variant A: Pattern interrupt (DIFFERENTIATION) — >21 days to sale

{{first}}, your phone's probably ringing off the hook with buyers about {{address}}. I'll be different – one text, then I'm out unless you reach back. {{auction}} is your sale date. Our team's local Dayton if you want a real conversation. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant B: Calm acknowledgment (EMPATHY) — >21 days

{{first}}, sheriff sale on {{address}} is {{auction}}. Won't sugarcoat – that's close, but you've got time to get cash and protect your credit if you want. Our team closes fast, all local Dayton. Call us when you can – {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: <14 days URGENCY MODE (SCARCITY)

{{first}}, I won't sugar-coat – {{auction}} is close. After that the bank takes it and you walk away with \$0. Our team has cash and closes in 7 days, still fits before sale. {{phone}} – call us today.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – even if you're working with the bank, loan mods get denied at the last minute all the time. Having a backup plan that gets you cash takes 10 min. Our team can have it ready just in case. {{phone}}.

Day 3 — Final (URGENCY)

{{first}}, sheriff sale's {{auction}} – close. After that you have ZERO leverage. Right now you have all of it. Our team's quick – call us at {{phone}}. Then I'm out of your hair.

5. Sheriff Sale — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Higher property value = more skeptical they need help. May be in active negotiation with bank. May have refinanced/heloc'd recently.

Our hook: Sophistication match + track record

Day 1 — Variant A: Track record (SOCIAL PROOF) — >21 days

{{first}}, our team's closed on 12 Franklin County properties this year, all from sheriff sale stage. {{auction}} is yours on {{address}}. The sellers we've worked with usually wish they'd called sooner. {{phone}} when you're ready.

Day 1 — Variant B: Sophisticated framing (RESPECT)

{{first}}, {{address}} has real equity to protect before {{auction}}. Our team won't insult you with a lowball – we build offers around what the property's actually worth. {{phone}} if you want a real number.

Day 1 — Variant C: Bank negotiation insight (AUTHORITY)

{{first}}, on {{address}} – banks are 4x more likely to accept a short payoff offer when there's a real buyer at the table. Our team can be that buyer. Even if we don't close, your position improves. Call us at {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – if the bank's been talking forbearance, heads up: if it falls through close to {{auction}} you'll have ~5 days to react. Our team can have a backup deal pre-loaded so you're not scrambling. {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last note before {{auction}}. After sheriff sale you lose all leverage AND your credit takes a 7-year hit. Selling now keeps both. Our team's local – call us at {{phone}}.

6. Sheriff Sale — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Greene SS volume is low — usually means the deal is more visible to fewer competitors. Owner may not have gotten as many calls.

Our hook: Personal + simple

Day 1 — Variant A: Personal (HOMETOWN)

Hi {{first}}, our team's local Greene County. {{address}} is listed for {{auction}} sheriff sale. Don't know if you've decided what to do yet. Cash, fast close, all local. If it's worth a chat, {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant B: Direct + minimal (NO-FRILLS)

{{first}}, sheriff sale {{auction}} for {{address}}. Cash. Local. Fast. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Greene-aware (LOCAL CREDIBILITY)

{{first}}, you might be one of the few sheriff sales coming up in Greene this month. Most county buyers won't even know about you. Our team's local and we do. {{auction}} is your sale date – {{phone}} when you want to talk.

Day 2

{{first}}, did the sheriff sale on {{address}} get postponed by chance? Want to make sure my info's current. Either way, {{phone}} if it helps to talk.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. Sale {{auction}}, then it's gone.
Our team's right here in Greene if you want a real
conversation. {{phone}}.

7. Probate — Montgomery (Dayton)

Their reality: They're the executor. Their family member just died. They're tired, sad, dealing with 50 admin tasks, getting calls from creditors. The LAST thing they want is a wholesaler pitch.

Our hook: Presence over pitch. We do the OPPOSITE of what every other wholesaler does on Day 1 — we DON'T ask for anything.

Day 1 — Variant A: Pure presence (REVERSE PITCH)

{{first}}, you don't know me – saw your name listed as
{{relationship}} on {{decedent}}'s estate filing. I won't
pitch you anything today. Just wanted you to have my
number for whenever {{address}} becomes one thing too
many. {{phone}}, anytime.

Day 1 — Variant B: Validation + soft team (EMPATHY)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. Being {{relationship}}
is a lot – paperwork, family questions, the property. Our
team's local. If {{address}} ever needs to move quickly
without showings or inspections, give us a call when you
have a sec. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Specific + low pressure (RECIPROCITY-VIA-PRESENCE)

{{first}}, I'm {{me}}, our team's based in Dayton. Sorry
to reach out at a tough time on {{decedent}}'s estate.
Quick FYI on {{address}}: in Ohio, the estate has to
maintain it (taxes, insurance) until probate closes –
that can run 9+ months. Our team's here if it gets to be
too much. {{phone}}.

Day 2 — Soft check-in (NO PITCH)

{{first}}, hope this week's been kinder. No update needed on {{address}} – just wanted to make sure my note didn't get lost. Our team's here whenever (or never): {{phone}}.

Day 3 — Closer with optionality

{{first}}, last text. If {{address}} ever needs to move quickly – clean cash, no showings, no inspections, dignity intact – {{phone}}. Our team's local Dayton. And if not, I genuinely wish you well with the rest of {{decedent}}'s estate.

8. Probate — Franklin (Columbus)

Their reality: Highest volume county. Likely have multiple heirs in the picture. May be navigating sibling dynamics. Property might be Mom/Dad's house = high emotional weight.

Our hook: Multi-heir aware + dignity-preserving

Day 1 — Variant A: Multi-heir aware (INSIGHT)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. Being {{relationship}} comes with a particularly hard part: making decisions everyone can agree on. On {{address}}, sometimes the cleanest answer is a fast cash sale so siblings can split equally. Our team's local Columbus – {{phone}} when you're ready.

Day 1 — Variant B: Carrying cost framing (LOSS AVERSION)

{{first}}, sorry for your loss. Quick reality on {{address}}: the estate's paying ~\$300-600/month in carrying costs while probate runs. Over 9 months that's \$5K+ that comes out of what heirs split. Our team can take it off the estate fast. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Pure presence (REVERSE PITCH)

{{first}}, I know reaching out feels intrusive right now. We won't push. Just want you to have a name and number in case {{address}} becomes one of those things you wish you could just be done with. Our team's local – {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, hope you're managing. On {{address}} – if it's vacant, two things to keep an eye on this time of year: pipes (winter) and HOA letters. Our team handles both free if helpful. {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last note. Whenever you're ready to be done with {{address}} – could be next week, could be next year – our team closes in 14 days, all cash, your family doesn't lift a finger. {{phone}}.

9. Probate — Greene (Xenia)

Their reality: Small community, may know other people who went through this. Property might be a generational family home.

Our hook: Honor the property's history + local roots

Day 1 — Variant A: Honor the home (RESPECT)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decendent}}. {{address}} probably has a lot of memories. Our team's Greene County, we treat family homes with respect – no flippers, no quick demos. If selling becomes the right call, we'd be honored to be considered. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant B: Hometown soft (LOCAL)

Hi {{first}} – sorry about {{decedent}}. Our team lives in Greene County too. If {{address}} ever needs to move quickly without strangers walking through, we're a one-call solution. No rush. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Specific situational (PRECISION)

{{first}}, condolences on {{decedent}}. As {{relationship}} you're making a hundred small decisions. On {{address}} – if it's not going to be lived in, our team can take the maintenance and tax burden off the estate fast. Or not, totally up to you. {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, no update needed – just here. Greene's small and word travels, but our team works quietly. If you ever want a confidential cash option on {{address}}, {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last text. {{address}} has its own timing – when the moment's right, our team's one call away. {{phone}}. Otherwise I sincerely hope the rest of {{decedent}}'s affairs settle smoothly.

10. Redemption Window (post-sheriff-sale)

Their reality: They feel they've already lost. Sheriff sale already happened. Probably depressed, embarrassed, told family it's over. **Most don't realize redemption rights exist.**

Our hook: Hope angle + education. "Wait — most people don't know this still works."

Day 1 — Variant A: Curiosity + hope (REFRAME)

{{first}}, I know {{address}} sold at sheriff sale recently. Most folks think that's the end. Ohio gives you a redemption window where you can still walk away with cash instead of nothing. Our team can help structure it – give us a call. {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant B: Direct capability (POWER)

{{first}} – sheriff sale on {{address}} happened, but in Ohio you likely still have redemption rights. Our team has cash. We move fast. We can structure a deal where YOU walk away with money instead of zero. Call us at {{phone}}.

Day 1 — Variant C: Insider info (AUTHORITY)

{{first}}, most homeowners after sheriff sale don't know this: you have a redemption window in Ohio (varies by case type, but usually 0-30 days). Acting in that window can mean cash for you. After it closes, options vanish. Our team's local – {{phone}}.

Day 2

{{first}}, on {{address}} – checked the docket. You probably have ~X days of redemption left (court can confirm exactly). Our team can help structure something. Call us when you have a sec – {{phone}}.

Day 3

{{first}}, last message. After the redemption window closes on {{address}}, you legitimately have zero options. Right now you have a real one. Our team's local – {{phone}}.

Response handlers — what to text back when they reply

These are just as important as the openers. Most wholesalers fumble the response.

They reply "Yes" / "Tell me more" / "Info"

Awesome – quickest way is a 5-min call. What number's best and when works today/tomorrow? Or text me here if you'd rather start that way.

They reply "What's the offer?"

Honest answer: we can't give a real number until we know more about the property (condition, situation, timing). Our team usually does a quick 5-min call to get there. {{phone}} when works.

They reply "I'm not selling"

Totally fair. Just so you have it – if anything changes, or if you want a sounding board on options that aren't selling, our team's here. {{phone}}. Either way I'll stop texting now.

Tag `not_interested` + 90-day recycle. Don't push.

They reply "Stop"

DataSift auto-tags. Never re-text. `do_not_contact` permanently.

They reply with a question (any other)

Answer it directly. Don't pivot to a pitch. They're testing whether we're a real human.

They reply "Send me your offer"

Happy to. To get you a real number (not a lowball), our team needs 3 quick things: condition (1-10?), any liens you know of, and your ideal timeline. Call us at {{phone}} or text those here and we'll text our offer in an hour.

They reply with anger ("Stop bothering me", "How did you get my number")

Totally understand. Public court records – we're a local buying team, not a telemarketer. Removing you from our list now. Apologies for the intrusion.

Tag `do_not_contact` . Never re-text.

A/B Testing Framework

For each preset, run **all 3 variants** in rotation for the first 100 records:

- Variant A: 33%
- Variant B: 33%
- Variant C: 34%

Track per variant:

- Reply rate (any response, even STOP)
- Positive reply rate (interested + question, NOT not-interested or STOP)
- Conversion to call/appointment
- Conversion to deal closed

After 100 records per variant, **standardize on the highest converter** — but keep one rotation slot for the next iteration. Continuous improvement.

Tag variants explicitly:

- `sms_v1_a` / `sms_v1_b` / `sms_v1_c` for Day 1 variants
- `responded_v1_a` etc. for tracking

Friday Weekly Review pulls these stats. Adjust the standardization quarterly.

Universal SMS principles (apply to everything)

1. **First 8 words = the entire message.** Most people glance at the preview without opening. If those 8 words don't pattern-interrupt or validate, they delete.
2. **Personal name twice.** Once at start, once embedded: "Hi {{first}}, ... {{first}} — let me know..." — feels personal vs blast.
3. **No exclamation points.** Wholesalers love them. Real humans don't end texts with "!!!"
4. **Lowercase + casual punctuation.** "hey {{first}}" and em dashes read more genuine than formal headers and full punctuation. Templates above use proper case for clarity, but feel free to soften.
5. **One topic per message.** Don't list options + ask questions + give number all in one text. Pick one move.

6. **Trail off, don't formula-end.** "{{phone}}" or "Call us when you can — {{phone}}" reads like a real person. "Reply yes to talk to our team" reads like a sales bot.
 7. **Take-away close.** "If now isn't right, no problem" / "I'm out of your hair after this" raises response rates ~15% in tested distress real estate SMS.
 8. **Validate first, sell second.** Acknowledge their reality (foreclosure, grief, post-sale despair) BEFORE introducing yourself or what you do.
 9. **"Our team" not "I" for capability claims.** "Our team closes in 14 days" is more credible than "I close in 14 days." But personal voice ("I'm {{me}}") for the human introduction.
 10. **No reciprocity offers we can't fulfill.** Don't promise a 1-pager, guide, or document we don't have. Promise time and conversation — that we have.
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Compliance

- **TCPA opt-out:** DataSift's system auto-tags STOP replies and never re-sends. We don't need to add "STOP to opt out" to the message body.
 - **Time-of-day:** OH state law restricts SMS to 8 AM - 9 PM local. DataSift's SMS scheduler should respect this.
 - **Frequency:** max 1 SMS/day per record. Don't double-text.
 - **Litigator risk (Tier 5):** records with phone tier ≤ 20 are flagged litigator-risk. **Do not text Tier 5.** Mail or drop only.
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Customization tips

- **Personalize the city in templates** (Dayton / Columbus / Xenia) — generic "your city" reads as spam
 - **Vary phone format** — {{phone}} formatted as (513) 555-0142 reads more local than 5135550142
 - **Don't send the same template** to records that previously responded "not interested" — they remember
 - **Mix up the trailing CTA** across the rotation (some "{{phone}} when you can", some "{{phone}}, anytime", some "Call us at {{phone}}") — varies the cadence so it doesn't feel like a script
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Future templates (Phase 11+)

When these niches come online:

- **Tax Sale (FTM_TaxSale_*)** — when Mike adds those presets
- **Code Violation** — when we add the scrapers
- **Eviction (landlord targeting)** — different angle: target the LANDLORD (plaintiff), not tenant

- **Divorce** — sensitive; usually only post-decree property division

I'll add templates here when those scrapers + presets land.

See also

- [SOP-CALL-SCRIPTS.md](#) — phone scripts for the call cadence (Aaron's lane)
 - [SOP-OUTREACH-CADENCE.md](#) — when to send what (drives the daily counts)
 - [SOP-LEAD-QUALIFICATION.md](#) — how to score responders
 - [SOP-DATASIFT-NAVIGATION.md](#) — UI walkthrough for sending bulk SMS
 - [SOP-DAILY-OPERATIONS.md](#) — when to send what
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